R FOR DATA ANALYSIS · EDITING DATA · LESSON 5

05 attach(): type column names with ease

Attach a dataset so RStudio suggests its column names, and understand the masking messages.

BY THE END OF THIS SECTION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Attach a dataset with attach()
- Use autocomplete to pick column names
- Understand the objects are masked message

The R code in this lesson

```
# Attaching a dataset: it eases selecting column names
attach(Dataset)
attach(Demographic)

# Now RStudio suggests column names as you type
Demographic_1 <- Dataset %>% select(`Province Name`, `Sex of household head`,
                                    `Marital Status of household head`)

# When you are done
detach(Demographic)
```

What you will hear (times count from the end of the intro)

Intro Typing long column names exactly right can be hard. In this lesson, you will learn attach, which lets RStudio suggest column names as you type. You will also learn what the masking messages mean, so they never worry you. Let's make typing easier.

0:00 Here is our script so far. I add a new note: attaching a dataset. It eases selecting column names.

0:12 The function is attach. Attach Dataset, and then attach Demographic.

0:25 Run them. The console shows some red text: the following objects are masked. Don't worry. It means both tables have columns with the same names, so R tells us which one comes first.

0:45 Now let's see why attach helps. I write a new select line: Demographic underscore one, arrow, Dataset, pipe, select.

1:20 Inside select, I start typing: provin. RStudio shows a list: Province Name, from Dataset. I just press Enter, and the full name is written for me.

1:50 No spelling mistakes, no missing spaces. This saves a lot of time with long survey column names.

2:05 I add Sex of household head, and Marital Status of household head, the same way.

2:40 Run it, and Demographic one appears in the Environment: three hundred fifty two rows, three columns.

2:48 One tip: attach is helpful while you explore, but it can cause confusion if you attach many tables. When you are done, use detach. That brings us to the end of our R sessions. You have learned so much. Thank you, and keep practicing!